



Solutions.
People.
Energy.™



AFRICA GEOTHERMAL DATATHON 2026



PARTICIPANT SUBMISSION GUIDELINES

Submission Link : <https://forms.gle/trogXPPPhgyvjSzGE7>

1. Overview

The SPE Africa Geothermal Datathon is an opportunity for students and young professionals to develop solutions in geothermal energy based on real world data. This competition is organised in coordination with the Geothermal Technical Section (GTTS) and Data Science and Engineering Analytics Section (DSEATS).

This document contains all information teams require to prepare and submit their final entries. Read it in full before preparing your submission.

2. Eligibility & Team Requirements

2.1 Who May Participate

- Open to university students, recent graduates (within 2 years), and young professionals.
- Participants must register as a team. Individual entries will not be accepted.
- Each team must have a minimum of 3 members and a maximum of 5 members.
- Interdisciplinary teams (engineering, geoscience, data science, computer science) are strongly encouraged.

2.2 Team Composition Rules

- Each participant may belong to only one team.

-
- One team member must be designated as Team Lead and will serve as the primary point of contact for all official correspondence.
 - All team members must be registered participants of the datathon before the submission window opens.

3. Required Deliverables

Every team must submit all three (3) deliverables listed below. An incomplete submission, missing any single component, will be penalised.

D1

Code Repository (.zip file)

- File name format : Team_TeamName_Code_V1 eg. Team_Wakanda_Code_V1
- Must include a README.md with: project title, team name, problem statement, methodology summary, and instructions to reproduce results.
- All analysis notebooks (.ipynb or .py) must be clearly named, commented, and runnable.
- Ensure all dependencies are documented (requirements.txt, environment.yml, or equivalent).

D2

Technical Presentation Deck

- File name format : Team_TeamName_PPT_V1 eg. Team_Wakanda_PPT_V1
- Accepted formats: PDF (preferred) or PowerPoint (.pptx).
- Length: 10 to 15 slides maximum. Do not exceed this limit.
- Must cover: problem framing and understanding, EDA findings, methodology, key insights, limitations, and recommendations.
- Slide deck must be submitted via the Google Form
- Include team name and team members names and SPE member numbers on the title slide.

D3

5-Minute Explanation Video

- Duration: 3 - 5 minutes. Submissions outside this range will be penalised.
 - Must include verbal narration, silent screen recordings will not be accepted.
 - Content: walk through your methodology, key findings, and what your analysis contributes to geothermal energy understanding.
 - Upload to Google Drive or any publicly accessible cloud storage and submit the shareable link. File name format : Team_TeamName_Vid_V1 eg. Team_Wakanda_Vid_V1
 - Ensure the video is accessible without a login.
 - Video quality: 720p minimum. Ensure audio is clear and free of excessive background noise.
 - At least one team member must appear on camera or provide clear voice narration.
-

5. Submission Process

All deliverables are submitted through a single Google Form (link : <https://forms.gle/trogXPPPhgyvjSzGE7>). The form link will be distributed to registered members via email and the official Whatsapp communication channel as well.

5.1 Submission Checklist

Before submitting, confirm each item:

1. All notebooks run without errors from top to bottom.
2. Presentation deck is uploaded to the submission form
3. Video is uploaded and accessible without login.
4. Team name on the form matches the team name on the presentation and other files
5. Team Lead's email address matches the registered contact email.

5.2 Resubmission Policy

Teams may update up to three submissions with the latest submission labelled as Team_TeamName_Vx their submission at any time before the deadline by resubmitting the Google Form. The most recent submission before 23:59 EAT on 4 June 2026 will be treated as the final entry. Resubmissions after the deadline will not be accepted.

DEADLINE WARNING

The submission form closes automatically at 23:59 EAT on 4 June 2026. Do not wait until the final hour file sharing issues, slow internet, and last-minute errors are your problem to manage, not the committee's.

6. Evaluation Criteria

Submissions will be evaluated by a panel of judges drawn from the geothermal energy, data science, and petroleum engineering fields. Judging is blind to team identity during the technical scoring phase.

6.1 Scoring Notes

- Code Quality assesses readability, structure, inline documentation, and whether results are reproducible from the repository alone.
- Video Communication is assessed on clarity of explanation and ability to convey complex technical work to a non-expert audience.
- Judges may request a brief clarification in case there are any ambiguous items

7. Presentations during SAASC 2026

The top teams will be given a chance to present their solutions live during the SPE Africa Annual Students Congress 2026 taking place in Nairobi, Kenya. It is preferable if teams are there physically but we will create provisions for virtual presentations as needed.

We will inform the presenting teams of their participation within the first five days of July for their own planning.

8. Disqualification Conditions

The organising committee reserves the right to disqualify any team that:

- Submits after the deadline.
- Fails to submit the required deliverables.
- Submits work that is not original (plagiarism, use of pre-existing public solutions, or AI-generated analysis presented as human work without disclosure).
- Engages in any form of misconduct, including misrepresentation of team membership.

9. Intellectual Property

Participants retain ownership of their submitted work. By submitting, teams grant the SPE Geothermal Datathon Organising Committee a non-exclusive, royalty-free licence to feature, present, and publish their work (with attribution) in SPE Kenya communications, events, and reports.

10. Contact & Support

All official communication will be conducted through the registered Team Lead email address. Teams are responsible for ensuring their contact information is current.

- Enquiries: [Whatsapp Group](#) or [email](#)
-